

Problem statement: As AI-generated imagery reaches "near-perfect" realism, the boundary between reality and digital fabrication has blurred. For Instagram, a platform built on visual inspiration, this creates a trust crisis. Users are increasingly unable to distinguish between genuine captures, digitally altered photos, and entirely synthetic AI creations (images and videos). This leads to the spread of misinformation, unrealistic beauty standards, and a decline in overall platform trust.

Instagram's existing approaches such as reporting, captions, and post-hoc fact checks arrive after content has already influenced user perception. In a fast-scrolling feed, users rarely pause to question authenticity, especially when visual quality, social proof, and creator familiarity signal credibility.

You are a product manager at Instagram and you have been tasked with answering the following question by the Head of Product:

"How might we design a seamless, intuitive UX intervention for Instagram that empowers users to instantly verify the authenticity of visual content without disrupting the immersive nature of the feed?"

Guidelines:

- Focus on all the actors involved. Understand and state the constraints, if any
- Identify the target user segment and understand the target users' unmet needs
- Break down the problem into smaller components
- How you would measure success for the proposed solution. Define the metrics
- Minimise false positives (Instagram should not flag "real" content as "fake" / "AI")

Deliverables (within 3 hrs):

- Submit a 3-pager (min)* document in PDF/PPT format ONLY (excluding cover slides)
- Any supplemental files (survey results, etc.) that you may like to attach should be sent to: pmtech@email.iimcal.ac.in

*submission should have minimum 3 pages (excluding cover slides)
